

profiles. He found scholarships offering full room and board to anyone who was a National Merit Semifinalist. He was able to find several of these types of scholarships at different schools, which he said “creates a bidding war” for those who know to look for them.

There are many interesting stories and opportunities for scholarships. But even if you can't get any, there are other options for others to pay for your schooling.

Robert Farrington said that working for Target allowed him to have some of his tuition reimbursed when going to school for his undergraduate and master's degrees. This is another common tactic among those who successfully hack college. The strategy is frequently utilized by those pursuing graduate degrees, looking to further education to increase income potential. People get advanced degrees at little to no cost using employer- or military-paid tuition programs.

I took this approach, as my employer paid for my Doctor of Physical Therapy degree in full. My wife also got two master's degrees—an MBA and a Master's of Operations Research—after she began her career. She paid only for her books while her employer paid tuition costs.